

Episode 1: Born Amid a Reign of Terror

Based on Qur'an, Surah Al-Qasas (28) : 3-13

The story opens in a land gripped by tyranny. Fir'aun (Pharaoh) had exalted himself in the land of Egypt, dividing its people into factions and oppressing one of them — slaughtering their sons while sparing their daughters (Qur'an 28:4). Yet Allah willed otherwise: to favor those oppressed in the land, to make them leaders, and to make them the inheritors (28:5-6).

Into this darkness, Musa (Moses) was born. Allah inspired his mother: "Nurse him, and when you fear for him, cast him into the river, and do not fear and do not grieve — indeed We will return him to you and make him a messenger" (28:7). A command that seemed impossible to reason, yet carried with it a certain promise.

The small basket drifted, and was retrieved by none other than Fir'aun's own household — one day, as Allah later revealed, this child would become an enemy and a grief to them, though they did not yet know it (28:8). Fir'aun's wife, Asiyah, said, "He will be a comfort of the eye for me and for you. Do not kill him; perhaps he may benefit us" (28:9).

The heart of Musa's mother became empty with anxiety, and she nearly disclosed who he truly was, had Allah not strengthened her heart (28:10). She told his sister to follow him

from a distance. Since Musa refused every wet-nurse offered to him, his sister suggested a family who could raise him with sincere care — unknowingly pointing them back to his own mother. Musa was thus returned to her arms, so that her eyes might be comforted, she would not grieve, and she would know that Allah's promise is true (28:11-13).

Reflection: Allah's plan is often hidden behind events that appear frightening. A mother releasing her child to a river in obedience to revelation teaches that true trust in Allah (tawakal) means surrendering the outcome to Him after taking the means He commands — however heavy that step may feel.

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